

COMPUTER NETWORKS

Ex.No.3	Experiments on CISCO PACKET TRACER (Simulation Tool):
Date:	a) To understand the environment of CISCO PACKET TRACER to design a simple network. b) Analyse the behaviour of network devices using CISCO PACKET TRACER simulator. Design a simple network with multiple nodes and connect via networking devices available in the library. Perform simulation and trace communication behaviour of specified network devices. 1: Use only HUB to design a small network having 4 to 6 hosts 2: Use only a Switch to design a small network with 4 to 6 hosts. 3: Use both the device (HUB and SWITCH) for a network and find out the functioning difference between switch and hub. Find out the network topology implemented in your college and draw and label that topology in your observation book.

AIM: To study the Packet tracer tool Installation and analyse the behaviour of network devices using **CISCO PACKET TRACER**

INSTALLING PACKET TRACER

Windows

Visit the Cisco Networking Academy website (www.netacad.com).
Log in using your Cisco NetAcad account.
Download the Packet Tracer installer for Windows.
Run the setup file, accept the license agreement, and complete the installation.

Linux

Download the appropriate Packet Tracer package for your Linux distribution.

Open the terminal and make the installer executable:

```
chmod +x PacketTracer601_i386_installer-rpm.bin
```

Run the installer:

./PacketTracer601_i386_installer-rpm.bin

Follow the on-screen instructions to complete the installation.

The screenshot shows the Cisco Packet Tracer interface with the following components labeled:

- 1 Menu bar**: Contains menus used to open, save, print, change preferences, and other functions.
- 2 Main toolbar**: Provides shortcut icons for common tasks like open, save, zoom, undo, redo, and network information.
- 3 Logical/Physical workspace tabs**: Allows switching between Logical and Physical work areas.
- 4 Workspace**: The main area where topologies are created and simulations are displayed.
- 5 Common tools bar**: Provides tools to select, move, place note, delete, inspect, resize shapes, and add simple/complex PDU.
- 6 Real-time/Simulation tabs**: Toggle between real-time and simulation modes, control time, and capture packets.
- 7 Network component box**:
 - 7a Device-type selection box**: Contains device categories.
 - 7b Device-specific selection box**: Displays different models of the selected category.
- 8 User-created packet box**: Allows users to create custom packets to test the network; results are shown as a list.

b) Analyse the behaviour of network devices using CISCO PACKET TRACER simulator.

Scenario 1: Network Using Only a Hub

Procedure:

Step 1

Open Cisco Packet Tracer.

Step 2

From Network Devices, drag a Hub to the workspace.

Step 3

Drag **4 PCs** (PC0, PC1, PC2, and PC3) from **End Devices**.

Step 4

Connect each PC to the Hub using **Copper Straight-Through** cables.

Step 5

Assign the following IP addresses.

Device	IP Address	Subnet Mask
PC0	192.168.1.1	255.255.255.0
PC1	192.168.1.2	255.255.255.0
PC2	192.168.1.3	255.255.255.0
PC3	192.168.1.4	255.255.255.0

Step 6

Switch to **Simulation Mode**.

Step 7

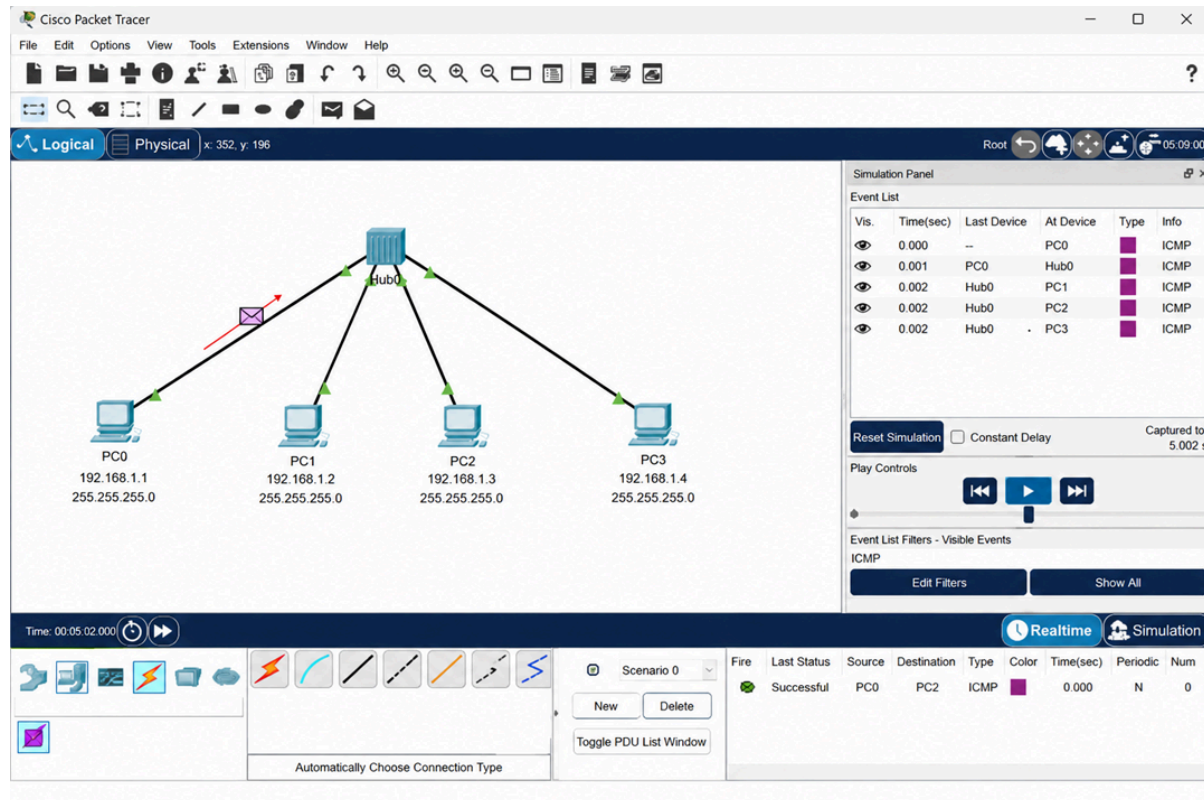
Click **Add Simple PDU** and send a packet from **PC0** to **PC2**.

Step 8

Observe the packet movement.

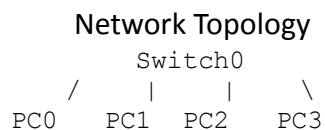
Observation

- The Hub broadcasts the packet to **all connected hosts**.
- Every PC receives the packet.
- Only the destination PC accepts the packet.
- Network collisions may occur because all devices share the same communication channel.



c) Scenario 2: Network Using Only a Switch

Aim: To design a simple network using a switch and observe the communication behaviour during simulation.



Devices Required

Device	Quantity
Switch 2960	1
PC-PT	4
Copper Straight-Through Cable	4

Procedure

Step 1

Open **Cisco Packet Tracer**.

Step 2

From **Network Devices** → **Switches**, drag a **2960 Switch** into the workspace.

Step 3

Drag four PCs (PC0, PC1, PC2, and PC3) from **End Devices**.

Step 4

Connect each PC to the switch using **Copper Straight-Through** cables.

Step 5

Assign the following IP addresses.

Device	IP Address	Subnet Mask
PC0	192.168.1.1	255.255.255.0
PC1	192.168.1.2	255.255.255.0
PC2	192.168.1.3	255.255.255.0
PC3	192.168.1.4	255.255.255.0

Step 6

Switch to **Simulation Mode**.

Step 7

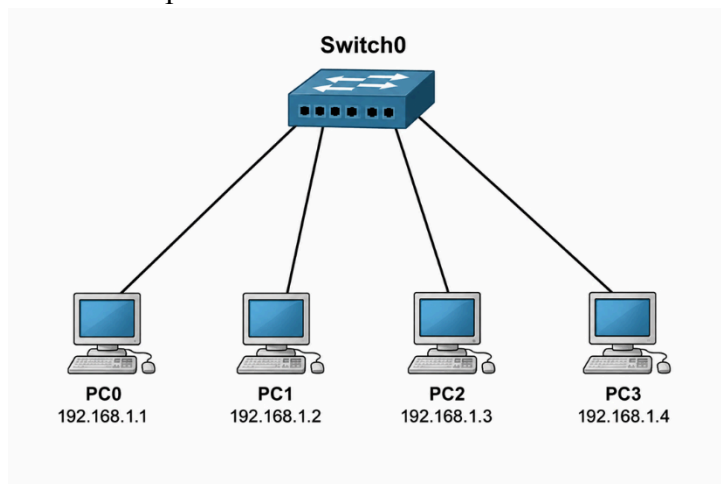
Select **Add Simple PDU**.

Step 8

Click **PC0** and then **PC2**.

Step 9

Observe the packet movement.



Observation

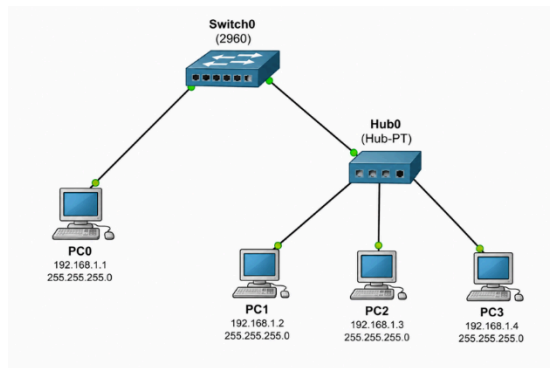
- The switch learns the MAC addresses of connected devices.
- Initially, the switch may flood the frame if the destination MAC address is unknown.

- Once the MAC address table is learned, the switch forwards packets **only to the destination port**.
- Other PCs do not receive the packet.
- No collisions occur because each switch port forms a separate collision domain.

Scenario 3: Network Using Both Hub and Switch

Aim: To design a network using both a hub and a switch and compare their communication behaviour.

Network Topology



Devices Required

Device	Quantity
Switch 2960	1
Hub	1
PC-PT	4
Copper Straight-Through Cable	5

Procedure:

Step 1

Open Cisco Packet Tracer.

Step 2

Place one **2960 Switch** and one **Hub** in the workspace.

Step 3

Add four PCs.

Step 4

Connect:

PC0 → Switch

Hub → Switch

PC1 → Hub
PC2 → Hub
PC3 → Hub

Step 5

Assign the following IP addresses.

Device	IP Address	Subnet Mask
PC0	192.168.1.1	255.255.255.0
PC1	192.168.1.2	255.255.255.0
PC2	192.168.1.3	255.255.255.0
PC3	192.168.1.4	255.255.255.0

Step 6

Switch to **Simulation Mode**.

Step 7

Send a Simple PDU from **PC0** to **PC2**.

Step 8

Observe the packet movement.

Observation

- The switch forwards the frame only toward the hub.
- The hub broadcasts the frame to all devices connected to it.
- PC1 and PC3 receive the frame but discard it.
- PC2 accepts the packet because it is the intended destination.
- The switch limits unnecessary traffic, while the hub broadcasts within its segment.

RESULT: Therefore the working of the cisco packet tracer and ip configuration of a message to be sent via the internet has been studied, simulated and verified.

